25900636 **Reg.No : .....**

Name : .....

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025

Third SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG3DSCSOC200 - FOUNDATIONS OF SOCIOLOGICAL THOUGHT

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1 Hour 30 Minutes **Maximum Marks: 50**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Very Short Answer

Answer any **13** questions

Each question carries **2** marks

1. Explain Herbert Spencer’s contribution to evolutionary sociology. [U] / [CO1]
2. Explain the concept of structural-functionalism. [U] / [CO1]
3. Explain the phrase 'survival of the fittest' as coined by Spencer. [U] / [CO2]
4. Mention one feature of Spencer’s industrial society. [U] / [CO2]
5. Do you agree that economy determines all aspects of life? Justify with an example [E] / [CO3]
6. State one difference between dialectics and metaphysics. [U] / [CO3]
7. Define 'social facts' according to Durkheim. [K] / [CO3]
8. List the four types of suicide identified by Durkheim. [K] / [CO3]
9. Explain one use and one limitation of ideal types in sociology. [E] / [CO3]
10. Explain the concept of totemism in Durkheim’s study of religion. [U] / [CO3]
11. Differentiate between functionalism and conflict perspectives. [An] / [CO1]

12. Differentiate between military and industrial societies described by Spencer. [An] / [CO2]

13. Give one example of a micro-sociological theory. [A] / [CO4]

14. Illustrate historical materialism using the Industrial Revolution. [A] / [CO3]

15. Define the term 'super-organism' in sociology. [K] / [CO2]

16. Define 'social solidarity'. [K] / [CO3]

[2x13 = 26]

Part B

Short Essay

A choice between two options for each question, answer five short answer questions, one from each pair

Each question carries **6** marks

17a. List the major four theoretical perspectives in sociology. [K] / [CO1]

OR

17b. Critically assess the limitations of Comte’s Positivism in modern sociology. [An] / [CO2]

18a. Explain the strengths and limitations of Durkheim's Division of Labour in contemporary organizations. [U] / [CO3]

OR

18b. Who is Karl Marx and what is his central contribution to social theory? [K] / [CO3]

19a. Explain the Theological stage with examples. [K / [CO2]

OR

19b. Explain the role of Religion of Humanity in promoting moral order. [U] / [CO2]

20a. Explain the criticisms of social action. [An] / [CO3]

OR

20b. What is meant by Hierarchy of Sciences according to Comte? [A] / [CO2]

[6x4 = 24]